BrightTime

DOCUMENTATION

Guide for Young People

Your own account, finding things to do, and staying safe

For anyone 13 or over with their own account

BrightTime is a countywide platform for out-of-school time. Families and young people find after-school, summer and weekend activities; the organisations that run them take registrations and record attendance; and the county's network organisers vet every organisation and listing.

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CHAPTER 1

BrightTime for young people

This guide is for you if you're 13 or over and have your own account. If you're younger, a parent or guardian adds you to their account; their guide is here.

Getting your own account

There are two ways.

Make one yourself. In the app tap **Create an account**, or use the website's sign-in page.

1. Say the month and year you were born. We never ask for the day.
2. Give your email address. We send you a link.
3. Open the link, choose a password, and come back to sign in.

If you're under 13, BrightTime can't make you an account. Ask a parent or guardian to add you from their own account, in the app or on the website.

Take over the profile your parent made. If a parent or guardian added you when you were younger, they can give you your own sign-in once you're 13. You get an email with a link: open it, choose a password, and sign in with that email address from then on. Your parent can still manage your consents.

You can add a **passkey** under **Account → Passkeys**, so you sign in with your phone's fingerprint, face or screen lock instead of a password.

Finding things to do

Search works just as it does for everyone: by words, age, kind of activity (programs, events, drop-in resources, jobs and internships), neighbourhood, price, and in the app **near me**. Jobs and internships are listed too.

Signed in on the app, you also get:

- **Picked for you**: a feed that puts your **interests** first. Each card says why it's there.
- **Saved** activities that follow your account, with reminders a day before a deadline or an hour before a session.
- An **inbox** and notifications, with **quiet hours** when your phone stays silent.

What your account can do

Under **Account**, the app lists **what your account can do**: whether you can sign up for programs yourself, whether programs can message you, whether you can post in groups, and whether you can upload photos of your work. It depends on your age and on consent from a parent or guardian. A program can also confirm your account.

To sign up for programs yourself, you need to **agree to the terms of use**. Read them under **Terms** in the app or on the website, and tap **I agree**.

Staying safe

- **You're signed out when you close the app, or after 30 minutes without using it.** That's so nobody else can use your account on a shared phone.
- **No adult is ever alone with you in a conversation.** If a program messages you, an admin of that organisation reads along, and you're told so.
- **BrightTime never keeps your home address or where you are.** *Use my location* picks the nearest neighbourhood once and forgets your position.
- **Sign out on all devices**, under **Account**, if you lose your phone or think someone else has used your account.

Your portfolio, badges and playlists: coming soon

These are built behind the scenes; their screens are next. When they arrive:

Your portfolio is a record of what you've taken part in. The hours come from attendance: each program you attend adds its sessions and hours.

- It's **private** until you choose to show it.
- You can **hide** any record. A hidden record leaves your total and anything you've shown, and you can show it again later. Nothing is deleted.
- You can show it to **anyone with the link**, or make it **public**. To do that you choose a **link name** (like `kwesi-builds`) and a **display name**, which can't include your family name. Anyone you share the link with sees your display name, a headline and short bio you write, your hours and your records. Never your account, your legal name or which programs enrolled you.
- A link-only portfolio is never shown to search engines.
- Showing your portfolio isn't open to anyone under 13.

Badges are awarded by the organisations whose programs you take part in, for something you did, like *River Surveyor*.

- Each badge is a digital credential in the **Open Badges** standard, so you can take it to other places that read badges, such as a college application or a professional profile.
- The badge never names you. It carries a scrambled code that only proves it's yours when you show it.
- Anyone can check a badge is real from its link. If an organisation takes a badge back (for example, it was given by mistake), the badge shows as **revoked**, with the reason. You still see it in your list, marked as revoked.

Playlists are sets of steps an organisation puts together, like *Watershed Explorer*, with a badge at the end.

- A step might be coming to one of the organisation's sessions, an activity somewhere else, writing a short reflection, or a check-in with a member of staff.
- Some playlists go in order, so a step opens once the ones before it are done. Some steps are checked by staff, who may ask you to do one again and say why.
- Finish every required step and the playlist is complete: you're given its badge.
- Some playlists, and some programs, are open only to people who hold a certain badge, or who have completed a certain playlist. The program's page says so before you apply.

Taking it with you. You'll be able to download your portfolio:

- as a **PDF** to print or attach, with your activities and your badges, each with the link where anyone can check it;
- your **badges** as Open Badges credentials, for a digital wallet or another platform;
- a **Comprehensive Learner Record**, a single credential holding your activities and badges that colleges and employers' systems can read. It's signed by your county's BrightTime, and each badge inside keeps its own organisation's signature.

Records you've hidden are left out, and your legal name never appears.

CHAPTER 2

About BrightTime

BrightTime helps a county's families and young people find things to do outside school, and helps the organisations that run those activities manage them. Each guide below is written for one kind of person.

If you are…	Read
A parent or guardian	Families
13 or over, with your own account	Young people
Someone who runs activities for an organisation	Organisations
A network organiser for the county	Network organisers

One person can be more than one of these. A parent who also coaches a team uses both the families and the organisations guide, with the same account.

Where BrightTime runs

- **The website**, on the county's own address (for the seed region, `kettle.localhost` in development). Anyone can search it without an account, and it works with JavaScript turned off, on a slow connection or an old phone. Organisations and network organisers use its **console**: the pages under *Your organisations*, *Review queue* and the other links that appear once you sign in.
- **The app**, for Android and iOS. It searches the same listings and adds what a phone does well: a personal feed, reminders, notifications, a family's consent centre, and taking attendance without a signal.

Languages

Everything is offered in English, Spanish, Chinese (Simplified), Bengali, Haitian Creole and Arabic. Choose a language at the foot of any web page, or under **Account** in the app. Arabic reads right to left throughout.

The translations are machine drafts until native speakers have reviewed them. A listing that was translated by machine says so.

What is ready, and what is coming

BrightTime is being built in stages. This table says where each part stands today, so that nothing in these guides promises a screen that doesn't exist yet.

	Website	App	Notes
Searching and browsing activities	Yes	Yes	
Saving activities	Yes (this browser only)	Yes (follows your account)	
Accounts, passwords, passkeys	Yes	Yes	
Children's profiles and consent	The consent email's link	Yes	
Agreeing to the terms of use	Yes	Yes	
A personal feed, interests, your area, reminders, notifications		Yes	
Organisations: profile, sites, staff, listings, import	Yes		
Organisations: forms, eligibility, waivers, applications, fees, attendance, messages, reports	Yes		
Organisations: taking attendance on a phone, offline		Yes	
Network organisers: review, taxonomy, wording, audit	Yes		
Families applying to programs, signing waivers and paying	Coming	Coming	Built behind the scenes; the family screens are next
A household's family profile and sharing it with an organisation	Coming	Coming	As above
Messages from organisations, and a family's own attendance	Coming	Coming	As above
A young person's portfolio, badges and playlists	Coming	Coming	As above
Organisations: playlists	Coming		As above
Organisations: badges	Coming		As above

Where a listing says "*Registration through BrightTime opens soon*", contact the organisation named on it to save a place for now.

Words used in these guides

- **Listing** or **activity**: one thing to do: a program, an event, a drop-in resource, or a job or internship.
- **Organisation**: a group that runs activities. Families sometimes call them providers.
- **Site**: a place where an organisation runs activities.
- **Network organiser**: the county's own staff, who check every organisation and listing before it goes live.
- **Consent**: a parent's or guardian's agreement, given one thing at a time, for a child under 13 to use part of BrightTime.
- **Share**: what a family chooses to let one organisation see about its members, and for how long.